New Zealand Rogaining Association (Inc) **12th April 2004**
http://www.rogaine.org.nz/

NZRA Newsletter - April 2004

Annual General Meeting

The AGM was held last Wednesday, 7th April. It was a fruitful meeting with a wide range of issues being discussed. The following summarises the outcomes of most interest:

President's Report

See the end of this Newsletter.

Election of Officers:

President: Peter Squires
Secretary: Tom Barnfield
Treasurer: Bruce Meder
Committee: Phil Bones, Chris Byrch, Andy Buchanan, Mark Copeland, Peter Dilks, Grant Hunter, Dave Laurie
Website/Membership: (Coopted onto committee) Bill Kennedy, Jude Elliot
IRF Representative: Peter Squires

Auditor Wanted

NZRA needs an auditor for the Accounts. Anybody wishing to volunteer or who knows someone who may volunteer should contact Pete Squires.

Other

1. The 2005 New Zealand Championships are to be held on 26th/27th February in Otago with Bob Cunninghame as controller.
2. NZRA is to work with NZOF to agree on a set of Rules and Technical Requirements for Rogaining in New Zealand. These rules would apply to Championship events and would give guidance to organisers of other events without impinging on the special character of those events.
3. NZRA will purchase (i) two GPS units for use by course setters and (ii) two copies of the manual "Organising a Rogaine" by Rod Costigan and published by the International Rogaining Federation for reference by organisers.
4. Dave Laurie was appointed Gear Controller and Map Archiver.
5. The safety plan developed by Grant Hunter is to be reviewed and is to be made available on the NZRA website.
6. Members need to be notified of the existence of the International Rogaining Federation (IRF) and its website http://www.rogaining.com/ . There is a link from the "Relevant Links" section of the NZRA website. The IRF provides a world-wide focus for Rogaining.
7. The production of maps from better digital data is to be investigated.

Coming Events

There is a good range of events in the pipeline for the coming months. Details may be found via the Event Calendar at www.rogaine.org.nz .

Hawke's Bay "Nevis Ay Die" Rogaine – Saturday 17th April. There are 4, 8, & 12hr options. Entries close Tuesday 13th April, i.e. tomorrow. Download an entry form from http://www.rogaine.org.nz .

Hopefull Rogaine – Blenheim, Saturday, 24th April, 3hr & 6hr events. This will be another Barry Hope special organised for the Marlborough Orienteering Club. Download an entry form from http://www.rogaine.org.nz .

T'WALK - Canterbury, 8/9th May, 24hrs. This will be the 36th running of this event, organised by the University of Canterbury Tramping Club. Teams follow a fixed route. Details and entry form will be available at http://www.cutc.canterbury.ac.nz/twalk/ soon.

4hr Rogaine – Canterbury, Sunday 30th May. Organised by Peninsular and Plains Orienteers. Details will be on the PAPO website, http://www.geocities.com/paponz, shortly.

Lactic Turkey Multisport Bikes Piha Rogaine – Auckland, Saturday 12th June. See http://www.lacticturkey.co.nz/ .

Heights of Winter – Canterbury, Saturday 26th June is being organised by NZRA. There are 12hr and 6hr options. Details and entry form are available on the NZRA website http://www.rogaine.org.nz .

Australian Champs – Flinders Range, South Australia, 3rd/4th July. Kiwis have been specifically invited to participate. See the SARA website http://sa.rogaine.asn.au/ for details.

Recent Events

NZ Championships 2004

Full results are available via the NZRA website. These include pictures and comment. As a result of using SportIdent, an electronic device that records checkpoint visits, there is a full break-down of checkpoint visits and times for each team. Overall winners were Chris Forne and Phil Novis by a very handy margin from Hamish Goodwin and George Christison (winner of this year's Coast-to-Coast).

Naseby Hillbilly

This event, with 12hr and 6hr options, was organised by the Youth Orienteers of Dunedin with Bob Cunninghame as controller. It followed the cryptic checkpoint format championed by Bruce McLeod for Otago rogaines. A total of over 80 people competed. Winners of the 12hr were Jim Cotter, Rachel Barton, Eric Billoud, and Nick Flyger with the 6hr event being won by Aaron Prince, Penny Kane, Jamie Stewart, and Sara Wallen. Full results are available on the NZRA website. Thanks must go to Bob and his team for a great event.

Port Hills Twilight

The unusual time of 6 pm to 9 pm on a Sunday evening settled on by organiser Dave Laurie for the 2nd Port Hills Rogaine was successful with almost 100 people enjoying a pleasant evening traipsing over the hills above Christchurch. Bruce Meder and Mike Robinson were the overall winners. See the NZRA website for full results.

President's Report to 2004 AGM

The last year has seen a good growth in the number and variety of rogaines available to us all. This is of course most desirable. However it may be timely to highlight some potential problems which can occur if we have "too many events".

The first is land access. Because we tend to use standard topomaps, rogaining can easily change locations for every event, unlike orienteering where the investment made in creating a map demands that it is thrashed to death. However problems with access are increasing.

1. There are more and more deer fences being erected on farmland all the time, even by farmers who are not yet farming deer. We can't tell whether or not there are deer over the fence so we avoid those areas.
2. More land is being transferred into public ownership, mostly to the management of DOC. Experience has shown us that getting permission to use public land can be difficult, especially compared to the willingness we usually get from private landowners.
3. If we re-use the same area too many times, there is a risk of getting landowner burn-out, although there has been little indication of this so far.

The second potential problem is competitor burn-out from too many events. In the mid-1980's when the Coast to Coast became well established, many other organizations began putting on Triathlons. First there was the Cheviot triathlon, then the Hanmer one, followed by the Rangiora and Geraldine ones. They were all good events, organized in most cases by the local Lion's clubs as fund-raisers. More followed. Trouble is, it was the same group of competitors all the time, and they got sick of traipsing off to a different triathlon every weekend. The market was saturated, and people chose to go fishing, or mow the lawns, or have a picnic with the kids. The events died out through non-profitability.

We could potentially strike this problem. The frequency of rogaines, and the variety of them, may need to be monitored and controlled. To some extent this occurs informally at present but it is probably timely that we are aware of the risk. In the meantime it is indeed pleasing to see the number of new events which have emerged in the last year.

Finally, it seems that the next year is going to offer a good mix and a good timing of events. Let's all enjoy them.

Pete Squires.